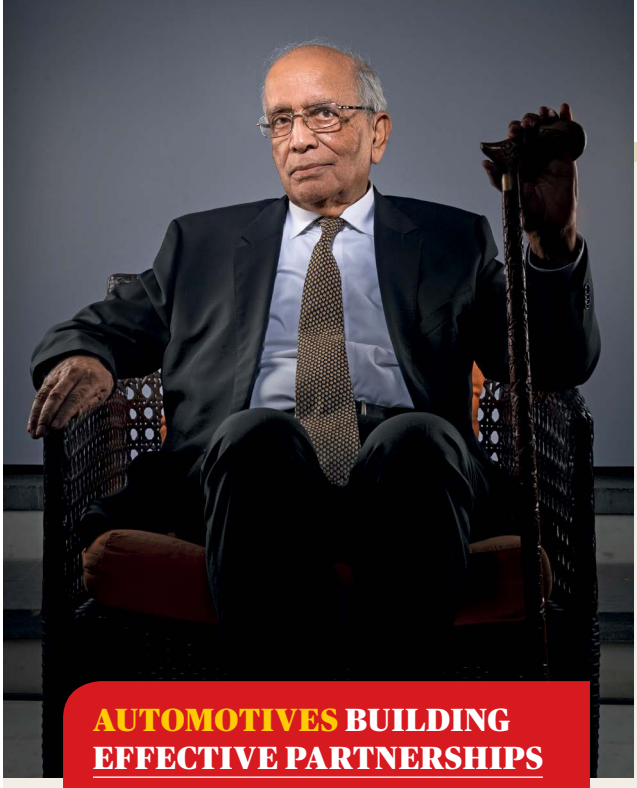


AUTOMOTIVES BUILDING EFFECTIVE PARTNERSHIPS

R.C. Bhargava *Chairman, Maruti Suzuki*

WORKERS ARE THE KEY

On Suzuki's eventful four decades in India and the company's future plans

How many Indian companies can claim to have increased their manufacturing capacity 20-fold, or have Rs 50,000 crore in cash reserves? **R.C. Bhargava** says it's only because of internal resource generation and the frugality of management. He feels Japan became the powerhouse it is now partly because of how industrialists handled worker-management relations.

THE GREEN VEHICLE PUSH

We need to use different technologies, keep changing our priorities as different technologies develop and find the most cost-effective method. We don't quite have the mix right at the moment.... When we start production of electric vehicles in the next financial year, we will also start exporting EVs.

ON HIS NEXT BOOK

For many years now in Maruti, we have implemented thousands of suggestions from the workers to improve processes in the company. We saved Rs 300-350 crore a year from these suggestions. What I'm trying to say in *Impossible to Possible: the incredible success of Maruti and the lessons for India* is that every management, if it really wants to become excellent, must realise the value of the resources it has in the company. ■

Uniting to Keep The Peace

India and Japan must join hands to maintain an open, inclusive Indo-Pacific region

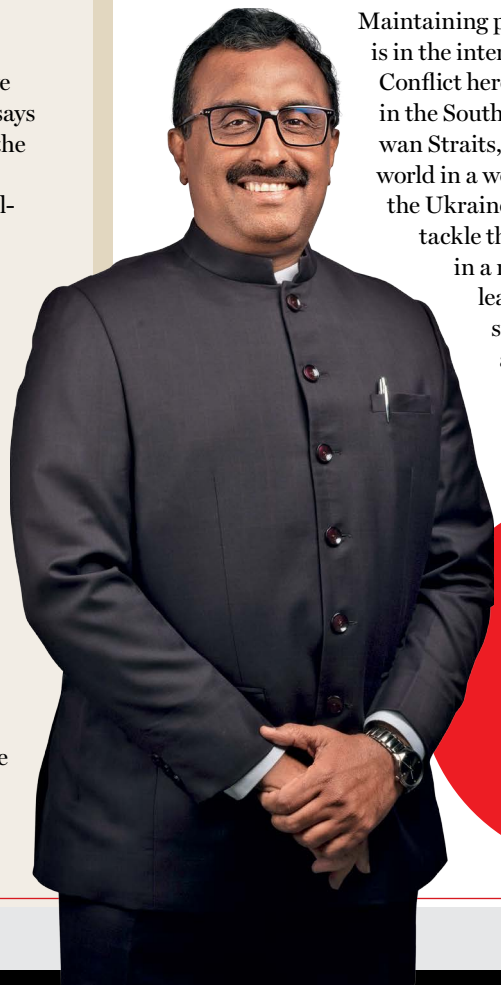
As the Indo-Pacific region is often beset by an assertive China, two Asian powers—India and Japan—have a role to play. **Ram Madhav**, president, India Foundation, threw light on the path the two nations need to tread to manage an aggressive China.

QUAD AND THE CHINESE THREAT

India and Japan can bring in strategic balance in the Indo-Pacific, where China is throwing its weight around. India and Japan can work together and play a balancing role in managing an open, free and inclusive Indo-Pacific region. The Quad is a very important partnership in today's era of mini-laterals that will decide the future of the region. However, India never subscribed to the idea of Quad being an Indo-Pacific NATO, a military alliance. It sees Quad as a non-militaristic alliance working on economic, humanitarian, scientific, technological and people-to-people dimensions. But the challenge from China will have to be dealt with by all Quad members.

CONVERGING INTERESTS

Maintaining peace in the Indo-Pacific is in the interest of the whole world. Conflict here, in the light of tensions in the South China Sea or the Taiwan Straits, would impact the whole world in a worse way than Covid or the Ukraine war did. We need to tackle the challenge from China in a manner that it does not lead to a war here. I'm sure Japan also has this as their ultimate vision. Our interests converge here. That's the best option. ■



GEOPOLITICS ASIA: THE NEW GREAT GAME

Ram Madhav *President, India Foundation*